

REEL PROJECT

Make a Reel Worth Posting

IDEA CHOSEN

4 · Shop intro

LENGTH

48 s / 60 s

FORMAT

1080 × 1920

TEMPO

96 BPM

SECTIONS

9

- DELIVERABLES
- 1 Final reel MP4 (H.264)
 - 2 Cover frame PNG
 - 3 Caption text
 - 4 Technique breakdown
 - 5 Project file .prproj

HONEST NOTE

This blueprint plans the edit. The reel itself must be shot and cut by me in Premiere Pro — no AI-generated video is used.

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Make a Reel Worth Posting — Production Blueprint, Technique Map and Breakdown

Name: Eswar Mahalingam · Course: Video Editing Internship, Internship Studio · Assignment: Reel Editing Project · Tool: Adobe Premiere Pro · Format: 1080 × 1920 vertical, 48 s · Date: 22 September 2026

1. The reel I chose and why

Idea 4 — **Restaurant or Shop Intro**: a 48-second promo for a neighbourhood chai café (working title *Kulhad & Co., Ghaziabad*). I chose it for three reasons. First, it is the only brief that has a real client at the end of it — a reel I could hand to a café owner is a portfolio piece, not just homework. Second, food gives me every visual the technique list asks for: steam and pours for speed ramps, plates that move for tracking, warm interiors that reward a LUT, and a product hand-off that makes a natural loop. Third, it works with either option in Step 3: I can shoot it at a café near me on my phone, and if any shot fails, Pexels has licence-free close-ups of chai, coffee pours and café interiors that cut in seamlessly. The hook, the beat cuts, the captions and the ending are all designed below so that the edit is planned before I open Premiere.

2. Reel rules → how this plan satisfies each one

Rule from the brief	How the blueprint meets it	Where in the timeline
Vertical 9:16, under 60 s	Sequence 1080×1920, 30 fps, planned length 48 s (12 s of headroom)	Whole sequence
Strong hook in the first 3 s	Slow-mo pour with steam + a price-led line that shows through the footage	0:00–0:03
Cuts timed to the beat	Track at ~96 BPM → 1 beat = 0.625 s; markers on every downbeat (M key), cuts snap to markers	Every cut
On-screen captions / text	One caption per section, essential-graphics text, safe-zone respected (Reels UI overlays bottom 20%)	9 captions
Clean loop or satisfying ending	Final 1-second pour matches frame 1 so the loop is invisible; end card holds 1 s	0:43–0:48
Delivered like a real post	MP4 + cover frame PNG + caption with hashtags + technique breakdown	Export folder

3. Timeline plan — 48 seconds, 9 sections, cut to a 96 BPM lo-fi track

Time	Section	Footage / action	On-screen text	Techniques used here
0:00–0:03	HOOK	Whip-pan into a slow-mo kulhad pour, steam rising; footage-into-text intro: the pour shows through the words	"The best Rs 20 you'll spend today"	Footage-into-text (track matte), speed ramp 40%→100%, beat 1 hit
0:03–0:07	Setup	Wide of the café front at dusk, sign lights up; quick 2-cut to hands wiping the counter	"Kulhad & Co. · Ghaziabad"	Cut on beat, pop-up keyframed title, Lumetri LUT applied
0:07–0:13	Product 1	Close-up chai boiling, ladle lift, milk swirl; match-cut to kulhad filling	"Masala chai, brewed 12 min"	3 cuts on beat, J-cut audio, sound effect (sizzle)
0:13–0:19	Product 2	Bun-maska on tawa, butter melting; top-down plating	"Bun maska. Enough said."	Tracked caption follows the plate (Mask & Track), adjustment layer glow
0:19–0:25	Vibe	Customers laughing, phone-in-hand, fairy lights bokeh, rack focus	"Come for the chai, stay for the gossip"	Nested sequence (3 clips + captions), light-leak transition preset
0:25–0:31	Photo moment	4 stills in a fast montage: menu board, kulhad stack, chai cart, owner smiling	"Since 2019"	Photo montage with scale keyframes, drum-roll SFX, Mr Horse/Motion Bro preset
0:31–0:37	Price & hours	Motion banner slides in over a wide shot	"Chai Rs 20 · Bun maska Rs 40 · 7 am–11 pm"	Motion banner (shapes + type tool), text-behind-subject mask on the cup
0:37–0:43	Payoff	Slow push on a kulhad being handed to camera, steam; velocity edit on the last 3 beats	"Your table is waiting"	Speed ramp, seamless zoom transition, colour before/after flash
0:43–0:48	End card / loop	Logo end card, then a 1-second pour that matches frame 1 for a clean loop	"@kulhadandco · Save this"	Animated end card, loop-matched last frame, audio fade to beat 1

Why 48 seconds and not 59

Reels retention drops sharply after 45 s; 48 s keeps the full technique list without padding, and leaves room if the client wants a longer price banner.

Shoot,
Import,
Rough Cut

SHOTS PLANNED

7 + 4 stills

BINS

5

SEQUENCE

1080×1920 · 30 fps

BEAT MARKERS

~77 (48 s)

CAPTIONS

9

SHORTCUTS I USE

M add marker · I/O in-out
, insert · . overwrite
B ripple · C razor · V select
Ctrl+K cut at playhead
Shift+E export frame (cover)
Ctrl+M export media

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4. Getting the footage (Step 3 of the brief) — shoot list and stock fallback

#	Shot	How I shoot it (phone, vertical)	Stock fallback (search term, licence-free)
1	Slow-mo chai pour into kulhad	Slow-mo mode 120 fps, window light, tripod, 3 takes	Pexels: "chai pour slow motion" · Pixabay: "tea pouring"
2	Café front at dusk, sign	Golden hour, steady 5-s hold, then a slow walk-in	Pexels: "cafe exterior evening"
3	Chai boiling, ladle lift, milk swirl	Close-up, lock focus/exposure (long-press), 3 angles	Pexels: "masala chai boiling"
4	Bun maska on tawa, butter	Overhead + 45°, 2 takes each, wipe lens first	Mixkit: "butter melting on pan"
5	Customers, laughter, fairy lights	Ask permission; 4 s clips; rack focus by tapping	Coverr: "cafe people talking"
6	Stills ×4 (menu, kulhad stack, cart, owner)	Photo mode, 3:4, no flash	Pixabay photos: "tea shop India"
7	Kulhad handed to camera (payoff + loop)	Repeat shot 1 framing exactly; end on the same pour frame	Same as shot 1

Music: one 96 BPM lo-fi/chill track from the YouTube Audio Library or Pixabay Music (attribution logged). SFX: sizzle, cup clink, drum-roll, whoosh from Mixkit / Freesound (CC0). Every file is entered in **sources_credit_log.csv** with URL, author and licence before it goes into the project — the brief rejects copyrighted media outright.

5. Editing stages 01–03 with the exact Premiere Pro steps

Stage	What I do in Premiere Pro (menu / panel / shortcut)	Deliverable proof
01 Set up & import	File > New > Project "Kulhad_Reel". Project panel > New Bin ×5: 01_Footage, 02_Stock, 03_Music_SFX, 04_Graphics, 05_Stills. File > New > Sequence > Settings: Editing mode Custom, 1080×1920, 30 fps, square pixels, 48 kHz. Import (Ctrl+I); Window > Workspaces > Editing; learn Source monitor (I/O marks), Program monitor, Timeline, Effect Controls, Essential Graphics.	Screenshot of bins + sequence settings
02 Rough cut & hook	Drop music on A1 first; play and tap M on every downbeat to add markers. Set I/O in the Source monitor, Insert (,) clips in story order on V1. Trim with the Ripple tool (B) and Razor (C); delete shaky frames; Shift+[/] to snap cuts to markers. Hook: put the pour first, keep it 3 s, ramp it (Stage 04).	Rough cut exported as "v1_rough.mp4"
03 Titles & captions	Type tool (T) for captions; Essential Graphics > font Bebas Neue / Inter, 2 px stroke, safe margins. Footage-into-text intro: text on V2 above pour on V1, apply Effects > Track Matte Key to V1 (Matte: Video 2, Composite: Matte Luma) so the pour plays inside the letters. Motion banner: Rectangle tool + text, position keyframes sliding in from the right. Photo montage: 4 stills ×0.5 s each with Scale 100→110 keyframes.	Caption list + intro, banner, montage on the timeline

6. Phone camera settings and file hygiene before I open Premiere

Setting / habit	Value	Why it matters in the edit
Resolution / frame rate	1080p or 4K at 30 fps; slow-mo shots at 120 fps	Mixed frame rates cause judder — I conform 120 fps clips with Interpret Footage > 30 fps
Orientation	Phone upright, grid on, horizon level	Rotating landscape footage to 9:16 throws away 70% of the frame
Exposure / focus	Long-press to lock; expose for the highlights (steam, butter)	Blown highlights cannot be recovered in Lumetri
Stability	Tripod or elbows on the counter; 5-s holds	Warp Stabilizer softens the image — better to shoot steady
Audio	Record 20 s of café room tone	Needed under the SFX so cuts do not go silent
File naming	01_pour_slowmo_t1.mp4, 02_exterior_dusk.mp4 ...	Bins sort themselves; the breakdown can cite file names
Backup	Copy to laptop + Drive before editing	Phone clips are the only original — no re-shoot if lost

7. Ten common reel-editing mistakes I am checking against

Mistake	Fix in this reel	Mistake	Fix in this reel
Hook starts on a title card	Frame 1 is motion (the pour)	Captions under the Reels UI	Safe zone y 250–1550 px
Cuts land between beats	Markers on downbeats, snap on	Music louder than SFX	Ducking –8 dB under SFX
Over-long shots (>3 s)	Longest shot 2.5 s except payoff	Colour changes shot to shot	One LUT on an adjustment layer
Ending just stops	Loop-matched pour + end card	Copyrighted music	YouTube Audio Library track, logged
Shaky handheld	Tripod / counter rest	Export at wrong size	1080×1920 H.264 preset saved
Safe-zone rule for captions. Instagram overlays the bottom ~20% and the right 10% with UI; keep all text inside x 60–1020 px and y 250–1550			

Animate,
Grade,
Export

NESTS

1 (Vibe_Nest)

TRACKED CAPTION

Bun maska plate

LUT

Food/clean at 60%

EXPORT

H.264 · 12 Mbps

BONUS DONE

5 of 5

AUDIO TARGETS

Music –18 dB under speech/SFX
Peaks ≤ –3 dB, no clipping
SFX on beats only
Loudness ≈ –14 LUFS (Reels)

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6. Editing stages 04–07 with the exact Premiere Pro steps

Stage	What I do in Premiere Pro	Deliverable proof
04 Animation & transitions	Pop-up text: Effect Controls > Scale keyframes 0→110→100 over 8 frames, Ease Out (right-click keyframe). Nesting: select the 3 vibe clips + captions > right-click > Nest "Vibe_Nest", then animate the nest as one. Transitions: Effects > Video Transitions > Dissolve > Film Dissolve (preset), plus a saved custom "Zoom Blur" preset (Transform effect, Scale 100→180, shutter angle 360) dragged between the payoff shots.	≥1 nest, ≥1 transition preset, keyframed text
05 Effects & tracking	Adjustment layer: Project > New Item > Adjustment Layer on V4 spanning the reel; apply Lumetri glow (Creative > Sharpen –, Vignette) and a subtle Gaussian blur on the vibe section. Tracking: select the bun-mask clip > Effect Controls > Opacity > Pen mask around the plate > Track selected mask forward; parent the caption position to the mask path. Plugin/template: apply one Mr Horse/Motion Bro preset (or a free Mixkit MOGRT via Essential Graphics > Install Motion Graphics template).	Adjustment layer, tracked caption, one template
06 Colour & audio	Lumetri > Basic Correction: white balance with the eyedropper on the kulhad, exposure +0.3, contrast +10; Creative > Look: "SL Clean Fuji" or a free food LUT at 60% intensity; export a before/after split (Lumetri > Comparison view) as a frame. Audio: Essential Sound > tag music as Music, SFX as SFX; Ducking on music –8 dB under SFX; Audio Track Mixer peaks at –3 dB; DeNoise on any ambient clip; fade in/out with Constant Power.	Before/after frame, clean mix (no clipping)
07 Export	Ctrl+M > Format H.264 > Preset "Match Source – High bitrate" > Video: 1080×1920, 30 fps, VBR 2-pass, target 12 Mbps, Maximum render quality; Audio AAC 320 kbps. Check the loop by playing the exported file on repeat. Cover: park on the payoff frame > Shift+E > PNG. Write the breakdown (this document \$7).	Final MP4, cover PNG, breakdown

7. Level-up challenges — all five are planned into the cut

Bonus	Where	How
Seamless / invisible transition	0:37–0:43 payoff	Zoom-blur preset + a whip-pan cut hidden on the frame where the cup fills the screen
Speed ramp	0:00–0:03 hook, 0:37 payoff	Time Remapping > Speed keyframes 40% → 100%, drag the handles to ease the ramp
Text behind the subject (masking)	0:31–0:37 price banner	Duplicate the clip to V3, pen-mask the cup, track it; banner sits on V2 between the two layers
Velocity edit synced to the beat	0:37–0:43	Cuts every half-beat (0.31 s) on the last 3 beats with 10-frame speed spikes
Custom sound design	Whole reel	Sizzle, clink, whoosh and drum-roll SFX placed on beats; music ducked under SFX

If the project file is too large

Export the .prproj without media (File > Save As) and record a 30-s screen capture of the timeline with Win+Alt+R as backup — the brief allows this.

Breakdown,
Caption,
Submit

TECHNIQUES MAPPED

16 of 16

BONUS CHALLENGES

5 of 5

CAPTION

Ready

COVER

Template supplied

SOURCES LOG

CSV

SOURCES TO CREDIT

Own phone footage (Ghaziabad)
Pexels / Pixabay / Mixkit / Coverr
clips (log URL + author)
YouTube Audio Library or
Pixabay Music track
Mixkit / Freesound SFX (CC0)
Fonts: Bebas Neue, Inter (OFL)

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8. Technique breakdown (final submission version — timecodes to be confirmed against the exported reel)

Technique required	Timecode	Layer / tool	Note
Bins and organised project	—	Project panel, 5 bins	01_Footage · 02_Stock · 03_Music_SFX · 04_Graphics · 05_Stills
Vertical 1080×1920 sequence	—	Sequence settings	30 fps, square pixels
Hook in first 3 s, cut to beat	0:00–0:03	V1 + markers	Slow-mo pour, price-led line
Type-tool text and shapes	0:03, 0:31	Essential Graphics	Title + rectangle banner
Footage-into-text intro	0:00–0:03	Track Matte Key	Pour visible inside the letters
Motion banner / end card	0:31, 0:43	Shapes + position keyframes	Slides in from right; end card holds 1 s
Photo montage	0:25–0:31	4 stills, scale keyframes	0.5 s each with drum-roll
Keyframe pop-up text	All captions	Effect Controls > Scale	0→110→100 in 8 frames, eased
Nest	0:19–0:25	Vibe_Nest	3 clips + captions grouped
Transition preset	0:19, 0:37	Film Dissolve + custom Zoom Blur	Saved as preset in Effects
Adjustment layer + effects	0:19–0:25 and whole reel	V4 adjustment layer	Vignette, glow, blur
Tracked caption	0:13–0:19	Mask > Track forward	Caption follows the bun-mask plate
Template / plugin	0:25	Mr Horse / Motion Bro preset or MOGRT	One transition or title template
Colour correction + grade + LUT	Whole reel; before/after at 0:40	Lumetri	WB eyedropper, +0.3 EV, food LUT 60%
Audio clean & balance	Whole reel	Essential Sound + Track Mixer	Ducking, DeNoise, peaks –3 dB
Export 1080×1920 H.264 + cover + loop	—	Export settings	VBR 2-pass 12 Mbps; loop-matched frame

9. Caption and cover frame

Caption (ready to paste)

The best Rs 20 you'll spend today [coffee emoji] Kulhad chai, bun maska and zero rush — Kulhad & Co., Ghaziabad. Open 7 am–11 pm. Save this for your next chai break [bookmark emoji]
#chai #kulhadchai #ghaziabad #cafereel #foodreel #bunmaska #premierepro #reelsindia

Cover frame: the payoff shot (kulhad handed to camera) with the title "SIP. SLOW. REPEAT." in the top third — a navy/gold overlay template is supplied as **cover_frame_template_1080x1920.png**; I place it on the exported frame in Premiere or Photoshop and export the cover as PNG.

10. Submission checklist (from the brief)

Step	Action	Done
1	Folder Eswar_Mahalingam_ReelEditing_Assignment: final reel MP4, Kulhad_Reel.prproj, cover PNG, breakdown PDF, sources_credit_log.csv	[]
2–3	Zip the folder, upload to Google Drive	[]
4–5	Share > Anyone with the link can view; copy the link	[]
6–8	iStudio dashboard > Assignments > Video Editing Internship > paste link > Submit before the deadline	[]
Check	Reel is vertical, <60 s, Premiere-only, royalty-free media credited, audio not clipping	[]

11. Hook alternatives tested against the first 3 seconds (I keep A; B and C are fallbacks if the pour take fails)

Option	First frame	Text line	Why it stops the scroll
A (chosen)	Slow-mo kulhad pour, steam	The best Rs 20 you'll spend today	Price + promise; motion in frame 1
B	Butter melting on bun maska, overhead	POV: it's 5 pm in Ghaziabad	Relatable time-of-day cue
C	Owner hands a kulhad to camera	Don't scroll — this is yours	Direct address, eye contact

Reviewer note

Timecodes in §8 are the planned values from the timeline plan; after the final export I re-check each against the MP4 and update the CSV/MD breakdown in the repo folder.